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Hiring Team, Growth Marketing, Thumbtack

Paid search at a two-sided marketplace is a different problem from paid search on a single-sided funnel. The intent signal has to move the customer side, but the LTV math has to balance against pro-side payback. The winning SEM operator treats bidding as a closed loop between Ads, Data Science, and Engineering, not as a campaign console. I have run that loop at smaller scale and am built for the next one.

Three tracks that map to the JD.

Paid search, owned from scratch. At Plug Power I owned the full Paid Search and Paid Social program for a B2B hydrogen-energy audience on Google Ads, SA360, Meta, and LinkedIn. A/B testing on keywords, match types, creatives, and landing pages delivered -25% CPA and +20% conversion. I cut wasted spend 15% through auction-insight work and quality-score optimization. I also built the MarTech stack that underneath it (Salesforce + Adobe Analytics + Adobe Audience Manager + GA + GTM) so the attribution model actually closed the loop from ad click to SQL.

Scaled budget on an AI adtech platform. At Pixis I managed \$1.4M in media spend across 8 enterprise clients on an AI adtech SaaS. Weekly optimization cycles on Google, Meta, and programmatic. 3x ROAS in 30 days for a leading fashion brand via smart bidding + creative A/B tests + lookalikes. Client churn down 50%. I was the translation layer between ML product and customer GTM, which is exactly the partnership shape the JD describes between Growth Marketing and Data Science.

AI fluency is not a resume line for me, it is how I work. I founded SwipeHire, a production AI product on OpenAI API + React (50+ users, 8+ A/B tests, +25% activation). I run a Claude draft-and-critique pipeline for ad copy variants: one Claude call drafts five per brief, a second scores against the conversion signal, a human gate approves. 8x variant velocity at Pixis-comparable volume. I hold four Anthropic Claude certifications including Building with the Claude API.

On the JD specifics: TROAS + LTV bidding covered through Pixis smart-bidding and Plug Power payback modeling. iROAS methodology (geo holdouts, ghost bidding) understood but not run at Thumbtack scale; I'll be direct about it and lean on your Data Science partner in the first 90 days. Cross-functional with DS and Eng is default: Sensata 100+ feature Agile backlog across 3 regions, Plug Power MarTech integration with IT and engineering.

On years: posting asks for 8+, I have 4+ plus founder experience. Real gap. Worth 20 minutes if scope and AI fluency matter more than ticker-count years.

MS Marketing Analytics (Simon, Rochester); BE Mechanical (BITS Pilani). Virtual-First removes the relocation question.

Resume and portfolio: adhithyabhaskar.vercel.app/ref/thumbtack

Would welcome 20 minutes on where the paid search program has the most headroom and what the first three experiments should be.

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